

ACTIVITY 3

LEVELS:

Grade 12, University Preparation

COURSES:

Canada and World Issues
HEV.03, GC1.01, HE1.03,
UC2.03

TASK:

Through group work, students
examine the issues of sustainable
development

EXPECTATIONS

The student will:

- Analyse the impact of human activities on the environment in Canada.
- Identify current global issues and environmental threats in Canada.
- Explain how Canadians perceive resources and sustainable development differently at different times and in different places.
- Identify the role played by government, NGOs and individuals in promoting sustainable development and resource management.

TIMEFRAME:

45 Minutes

ACHIEVEMENT CATEGORIES:

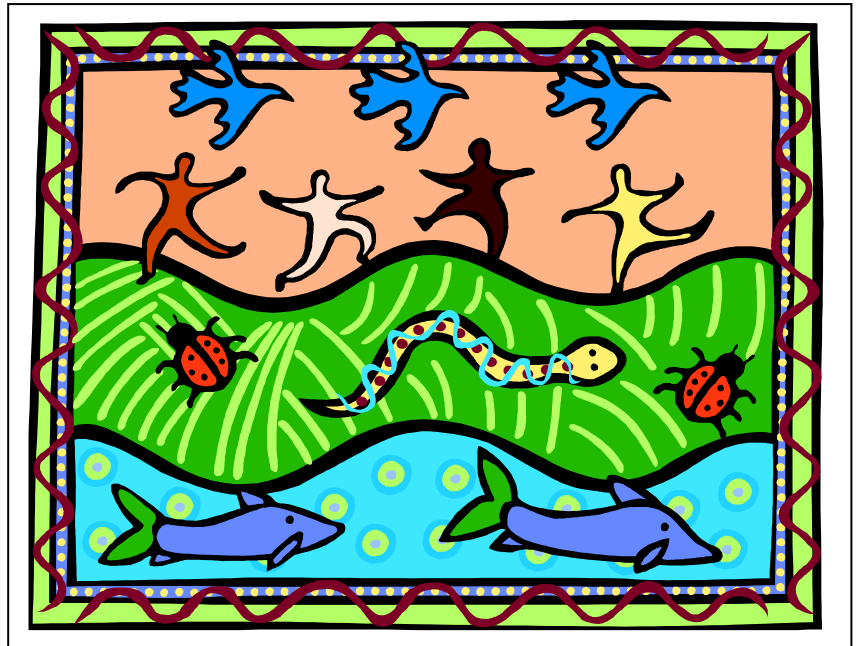
Knowledge / Understanding
Thinking / Inquiry
Communication
Application / Making Connections

MATERIALS:

Flipchart paper and markers
Worksheet 2, 3, and 4
Appendix 1 and 2

VOCABULARY:

Non-governmental Organisations



Dismantling Sustainable Development

⁸UNAC. 2002. "Mapping the Mind Maze". Youth Agenda 2002.

PROCEDURE

1. Introduce the definition of Sustainable development using the information on the Sustainable Development Fact sheet (See Appendix 1: The Sustainable Development Fact Sheet), the Sustainable Development Timeline (See Appendix 2: the Sustainable Development Timeline) and by using your background material found in the introduction. Your introduction to the class should include the origins of sustainable development, the definition, and an outline of some of the main concepts of sustainable development (See Appendix 1: The Sustainable Development Fact Sheet).
2. Divide the class into groups of 4-5.
3. Ask the students to come up with a list of issues that they think are part of sustainable development (See Worksheet 2). These issues should reflect the values they identified in "The Yarn of Life".
4. Write all the issues on the board from all groups.
5. Back in their groups, students choose the five most important issues for Canada's progress towards sustainable development and write them on the chart provided (See Worksheet 3). Students are then asked to rank the issues from their selection in order of importance (1 - Most important to 5 - Least important). Students are then asked to tape their rankings to the wall.
6. As a class, students are asked to come up with one set of issues for the whole class, based on the lists created by each group.
7. Once complete, students are asked to decide who is responsible for the priority issues listed by the class. Students can use the table provided to record their answers (See Worksheet 4). Place an asterisk beside the category you feel has the most responsibility for each issue.
8. Have each student write the class charter in their notebook so they have a copy.

SUGGESTED HOMEWORK (See Suggested Homework 1)

Review your class charter on sustainable development and list five ways that you can incorporate these issues into your lives. Do some research on how you might be able to go about adopting these initiatives. For example, find out what local organizations are involved in the issue, explore some of the websites listed on your fact sheet for ideas, speak to your parents about creating a family charter for sustainable development.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS ON DISMANTLING SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

KNOWLEDGE / UNDERSTANDING

1. Discuss what influenced your choice in priorities for sustainable development.
2. After completing Worksheet 3, discuss the question “who is responsibility for sustainable development?” as a group.

APPLICATION / MAKING CONNECTIONS

1. How will the priorities you identified achieve sustainable development?

THINKING / INQUIRY

1. Review your sustainable development priorities. Do you think they are achievable?
2. What might be some of the challenges to adopting your sustainable development priorities?
3. To what extent is the responsibility of sustainable development an individual responsibility?
4. Is one group more responsible than other for sustainable development?
5. As youth, do you feel you have a role to play in sustainable development?